

local pond kind of kids. But when my elder sister came back from Canada after 4 years away, what she brought back from the land of maple syrup and hockey would go on to define the person I am today. What I'm talking about is the original Nintendo Gameboy bundled with Tetris and a game that I still think about to this day, Metroid 2: The Return of Samus. Sure, I'd gotten my hands on the Atari 2600 but those blocky graphics just could not stand up to the two-toned colour of the Gameboy. Just opening up the box was an experience in itself. Finally, I turned it on and the now iconic *ping* welcomed me to a magical world of space pirates, parasitic monsters and the coolest hero on this side of the galaxy in Samus Aran. Suffice it to say, my 7-year-old brain promptly melted when I discovered that Samus was a girl after I finally completed the game. I can still remember exactly where I was when it happened, it's such a vivid memory. The intro screen. The green dot matrix. The minimalistic controls. It was all very new at the time. In the years that followed, I amassed a respectable collection of games like the critically acclaimed TMNT: Fall of the Foot Clan, The Toxic Avengers, Castlevania 2: Belmont's Revenge, Super Mario Land, Robocop and much more. The Nintendo Gameboy would be my first brush with the Japanese gaming juggernaut and it's a relationship that has continued to this day. I've practically owned almost every Nintendo console out there, barring the Virtual Boy. We'll talk about the various Gameboy Variants in a bit but for



the Chinese community in India, I had a network of bros who were as deep into gaming as I was. We'd meet once a year in Calcutta, since I lived in Shillong, and compare our haul for the year. Now this dude struts in with a brand new, all-colour handheld device and we're stuck here with a crappy dot matrix screen! I'd never seen a console like that before. It was bulky and looked menacing and unlike the Nintendo Gameboy which used 4 AAA batteries, this behemoth was powered by 6 AAA batteries. Holding it felt surreal. The colours burned my retina through the tiny screen. The first game I experienced on the console was Shinobi. Just watching the white ninja sashay across the screen in full colour, back-lit was an experience I'll never forget. The next game I played on the handheld shaped the way I looked at fighting games. Mortal Kombat 2 on the Game Gear was a revelation for me. The blood and gore of the gruesome fatalities and the life-like graphics did a number on me. It was also the first time I ever saw a boss like Kintaro and he immediately became my favourite MK character. The game ran like butter on the Game Gear and even though I wanted one really bad, it wasn't until 1995

now, let's move on to Nintendo's biggest competitor back in the day, Sega.

My first brush with the Game Gear was through a friend of a friend of a friend, sometime in 1993. As part of

did I finally get my cousin's hand-me-down console. Better late than never, right? The one thing that stood out to me when comparing the Game Gear to the Gameboy is